

Twitter turns four

Twitter, the microblogging phenomenon turned four in March

Hands-on video

NVIDIA shows us two incredible 7-inch tablet PCs - the Compal and Indian made EAF Magic Tile (<http://bit.ly/a7mWRg>)

has a bright blue light. The base of the speakers have a layer of rubber, which ensures that the speakers don't slide around.

The next well designed speaker set was from Creative as well - the Gigaworks T40 Series II. The speakers are attractive, but the build quality isn't in the same league as the more expensive HD50.

The two speakers from F&D in the category were also pretty good. They are more compact, and draw power via USB. The F&D V520 are the cheaper of the two models. The V620 model was smaller but built better than the V520 and has a glowing base.

The models from Altec Lansing weren't particularly impressive. Of course, look and design are subjective. The volume for example, on the FX2020 is controlled using buttons and not a dial. The design change that Altec Lansing has adopted is a flat acrylic panel, which has a driver barrel at the center of it.

Some speakers, however, use somewhat conventional designs. The Altec Lansing FX3022, for example is adver-



F&D V620

tised as a 2.2 speaker set as it has a downfiring bass driver in each satellite. The Altec Lansing VS2620 are a slightly odd looking set of speakers. The design is a bit like a pyramid with rather flimsy stands.

In the case of the Zebronic ZEB-S2100, the design of the speakers



Zebronic S2100

isn't impressive and that's something we noticed about Zebronic speakers in general. Although they might be decent in performance, it has a very plain boxy design - simple, but functional.

Performance

We've tested them in the past and we still love them. We're talking about the Audioengine A2 again. The only complaint is the lack of bass, which understandably isn't its strong point. Highs are rendered beautifully, with decent precision. The mid-range frequencies are reproduced well, unless a good amount of bass is demanded, or other complexities are added to the mix. Still, it outperforms the others by miles.

The HD50 is decent however. The audio quality is very good - they aren't as vibrant as the Audioengine A2 but they come very close - a great achievement for a small speaker set. Low bass is almost non-existent and that's something best noticed in the woofer bass test track. The 20Hz is inaudible, 50Hz just about makes it and the rest works very well which makes a good contender for the number one spot in terms of performance.

The Gigaworks T40 Series II is definitely a big notch up on the HD50 in terms of power. In terms of quality, they are somewhat comparable. Although a



Creative Gigaworks T40 Series II

lot larger and more powerful, there is almost no benefit in the bass rendering department. The sounds are pretty neutral and bass-treble control set is provided if you feel like tweaking things a bit. There was clear distortion at higher volumes. Bass fails in some of the low frequency ranges.

The Altec Lansing FX3022 is good at higher volumes and there isn't any audible distortion in the sound. The high frequencies are well balanced and they don't get too shrill. Drums sound great, but we would have liked a little more punch. So, do the inbuilt woofers in the satel-

LOGITECH PURE-FI MOBILE

While the Altec Lansing iML237 is for the really portable type, those with space enough to carry a small umbrella should look at the Logitech Pure-Fi Mobile. In design, it's a single plastic bar with a rubberised back and four drivers built into the face of it. Build quality is rugged but styling has been maintained.

The speakers perform well - they are very loud for their size, but there is some distortion which is expected on something this compact and thin. The extreme high-end frequency range is audible, but a lot of detail is lost out. This is typically the region in which the cymbals of a drum kit are.

The party piece however is the inbuilt battery pack, which ensures you're never left powerless and music-less. Bluetooth support means there is no need for cables either. All this basically means that long train rides or picnics will no longer have to be entertained by small mobile phones. At Rs. 10,995, it's not exactly cheap, so you better be a very outgoing person.

